SOLIFENACIN

Once daily
Fewer CNS effects

CHEMICAL NAME (3R)-1-azabicyclo[2.2.2]oct-3-yl (1S)-1-phenyl-3,4-dihydroisoquinoline-2(1H)-carboxylate (succinate)
CLASS Selective M3 antimuscarinic (bladder)
TRADE NAMES Vesicare · Vesitirim (with tamsulosin) · Solifen

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Overactive bladder (urgency, frequency, urge incontinence).
- Neurogenic detrusor overactivity (children ≥2 yr, oral suspension).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily, swallowed whole with water, with or without food.

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 5 mg once daily, may increase to 10 mg.
- **Severe renal or moderate hepatic impairment / strong CYP3A4 inhibitors:** max 5 mg.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 3–8 h. Bioavailability ~90%.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP3A4).
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 45–68 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Competitive **M3 receptor** antagonist in bladder → ↓ detrusor overactivity; more bladder-selective than oxybutynin.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dry mouth, constipation.
- Blurred vision.
- Dyspepsia.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Urinary retention.
- QT prolongation (high doses).
- Angioedema (rare); cognitive effects (less than oxybutynin).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Urinary retention; severe GI conditions (toxic megacolon).
- Myasthenia gravis; angle-closure glaucoma.
- Dialysis; severe hepatic impairment.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Ketoconazole, ritonavir:** ↑ levels — max 5 mg.
- **Other anticholinergics:** additive.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess bladder diary and continence.
- Check post-void residual if symptoms of retention.
- Monitor bowel function.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take once daily; benefit builds over 4 weeks.
- Report difficulty urinating, severe constipation, eye pain.
- Continue bladder training.

KEY POINTS

- Bladder-selective M3 antagonist.
- Long half-life.
- 5–10 mg once daily.
- Dry mouth, constipation.